TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
BUDGET WORKSHOP AND
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 13, 2023
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Dr. Edward Drohan, 3319 Bannon Dr – Dr. Drohan stated he has an STR on Louis Street – noticed component of standard rules 6-302(A). Dr. Drohan says if owner is using a third party referring company such as AirBnB or VRBO, the owner shouldn't have to do monthly reporting or be required to have a tax ID. Town Administrator Milie agreed with Dr. Drohan's statement. Town Attorney Barrow added language to the STR Ordinance amendment to that effect.

Jan Yarbrough, 24 Bonaventure Rd – Asked if any members of Council own an STR anywhere? Council Member Drohan stated that he and Council Member Bethany Skipper-Greer have STRs. Ms. Yarbrough then asked if Council Member Drohan would be voting to which he replied "no, never have".

Meredith Allen, 3220 Falligant Ave. – asked about the new Town website and when it will be launched for public use. Mayor Williams stated he wanted the new website up within 48 hours. Ms. Allen then asked regarding the Ordinance updates that were supposed to take place. Town Administrator Milie stated the Town had one workshop session, but a transition in staff slowed the process. He stated the updates were tabled and will resume in 2024.

Mayor Williams stated that Christmas on the Bluff had an estimated 1000-1200 people in attendance. It was a great event with positive feedback. He acknowledged the parking issues at the event. He also thanked everyone who made the event possible.

Mayor Williams stated there was a water issue due to a fire hydrant being struck by a vehicle. He encouraged anyone with water pressure issues to contact Town Hall. Town Administrator Milie stated more valves would be installed in 2024 to isolate leaks to limit those affected. He applauded the dedicated Department of Public Works employees for their hard work.

Town Administrator Milie stated he would like to see the website launched within 48 hours also. He stated the Tompson Park bids are in, but the item is being tabled to next month. The Town is going to handle the demolition portion to cut costs on the replacement. He also stated the Town is working on collecting back taxes owed. 2016-2021 is estimated at $72,000. The tax debt owed for 2022 will be lower. The business license approvals will be subject to debt owed to the Town. The Town is addressing the speeding issue on Bonaventure Rd. aggressively. A discussion was had regarding adding a speed bump or two along the Thunderbolt side of Bonaventure Rd. Police Chief Clayton and Fire Chief Bateman both stated they are not opposed to one speed hump placed in that area.

Mayor Williams closed the public hearing at 6:38 pm.

Mayor Williams opened the 2024 Budget Hearing at 6:39 pm.

Town Administrator Milie stated there were no public comments made at the first two budget hearings. He then went on the discuss the 2024 Annual Budget with larger infrastructure goals. He stated there is no significant revenue changes. Expenses are at 11% growth, but this is due to Department of Public Works materials increasing in price. The millage rate was reduced by Mayor and Council. Town Administrator Milie reviewed the 10% increase in utilities based only on consumption and usage. It will allow funding better service and upgrades to equipment. There is no base increase, only an increase on consumption. There was discussion regarding the sanitation costs and possible changes to the number of pickups for trash and recycling per month. The SPLOST budget will be used for road and sewer maintenance and bigger issues like Shell Road infrastructure, improvements to parks and recreation areas, as well as $1.5 Million in water/sewer and system improvements.

Katherine Clements, 3324 Cedar Street – stated she did not support changing the trash and recycling service dates per month. She wants to ensure the vendor picks up everything, every time they come. If not, things get blown around the yard.

Mayor Williams closed the 2024 Budget Hearing at 6:56 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order** - Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:56 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Wiliams and Council Members: David Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Edward Drohan, James Lavin and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Police Chief, Sean Clayton; Utilities Clerk, Renee Holmes; Accounts Payable/Utilities Manager; Katina Spaulding; Interim Clerk of Council, Matthew Walker.

   Not in attendance Bethany Skipper-Greer.

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (adding items g, h, I, voter rights discussion, and waste collection discussion)**

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

   Minutes of November 8, 2023

   Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes November 8, 2023. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with meeting minutes November 8, 2023. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

   There were no presentations given.

6. **Finance Report:**

   Shannon Brett, Holland, Bromley, Barnhill & Brett, discussed the Town's Finance Report and current YTD expenses in regards to the budget. She stated the Town is in good shape and all accounts are in range with what was budgeted.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

a) Consideration to Approve Alcohol Licenses for 2024 – **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve Alcohol Licenses for 2024 subject to debts owed to the Town. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

b) Consideration to Approve Home Occupation Licenses for 2024 - **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve Home Occupation Licenses for 2024 subject to debts owed to the Town. Council Member Barbaree provided the second. The motion passed unanimously. (Council Member Crenshaw recused himself from the vote)**

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

a) Consideration to Approve LeadsOnline renewal for 2024 - **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve LeadsOnline renewal for 2024. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. Motion passed unanimously.**

b) Consideration to approve PD new vehicles purchase - **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve PD new vehicles purchase. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. Motion passed unanimously.**

c) Consideration to approve DPW new truck purchase – **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve DPW new truck purchase. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

d) Consideration to approve Town Hall HVAC purchase – **A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve the Town Hall HVAC purchase. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

e) Consideration to approve 2024 Annual Budget and Budget Resolution – **A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve the 2024 Annual Budget and Budget Resolution. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

f) Consideration to approve FLOCK Camera purchase – **A motion was made by Council Member Ward to purchase 2 FLOCK Cameras. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

g) Consideration to approve DPW Mower purchase – **A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve purchase of DPW Mower from Lawnmower Store. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

h) Consideration to approve Fire Department PPE purchase – **A motion was made by Council Member Drohan to approve purchase of Fire Department PPE. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

i) Consideration to approve seeking Brokerage Agreements for Investments – **A motion was provided by Council Member Crenshaw. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**

Chief Clayton had nothing further to add to his report. Chief Clayton stated the stage vehicle has helped with speeding along Bonaventure Rd.

Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman

Chief Bateman had nothing further to add to his report.

Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Public Works Director Crosby stated the Chlorides were at 20/ppm. He had nothing further to add to his report.

10. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator Milie went over some highlights from his report. He thanked the staff and said morale is up and he is excited for 2024.

11. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

Second Reading and Consideration to approve STR Ordinance amendments – **A motion was made by Council Member Crenshaw to adopt the Ordinance with one additional edit regarding requiring a tax ID. Council Member Ward provided the second. The motion passed unanimously. (Council Member Drohan recused himself from the vote)**

First reading Massage Parlor Ordinance – **Town Attorney Barrow stated he does not recommend adopting this ordinance because it is not needed. There are already laws that make these operations illegal and the Town just needs to make sure it is enforced.**

12. **Mayor and Council –**

Council Member Drohan discussed his opinion of the Bonaventure Road Traffic Issues.
Council Member Drohan discussed his opinion of Voting Rights Concerns.
Council Member Drohan discussed his opinion of the Waste Collection Systems.

13. **Thunderbolt Museum**

Anna Maria Thomas stated there will be an Oyster Roast event on January 28 to benefit the Thunderbolt Museum. The tickets will be $25/each. There will be other foods for those that do not eat oysters. There will also be raffles taking place. She discussed the need to block off the parking lot to the museum. She stated flyers will be going out.

14. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal, Real Estate and/or Personnel matters. **Council Member Ward made a motion to recess into executive session. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. Motion passes unanimously.**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to open back into the regular meeting. **Council Member Crenshaw made a motion with a second from Council Member Ward. Motion passes unanimously.**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Ward made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:22 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **13th** day **of December, 2023.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **13th** day of **December, 2023** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This **13th** day of **December, 2023.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Council Members

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this **13th** day of **December, 2023.**
Notary Public